

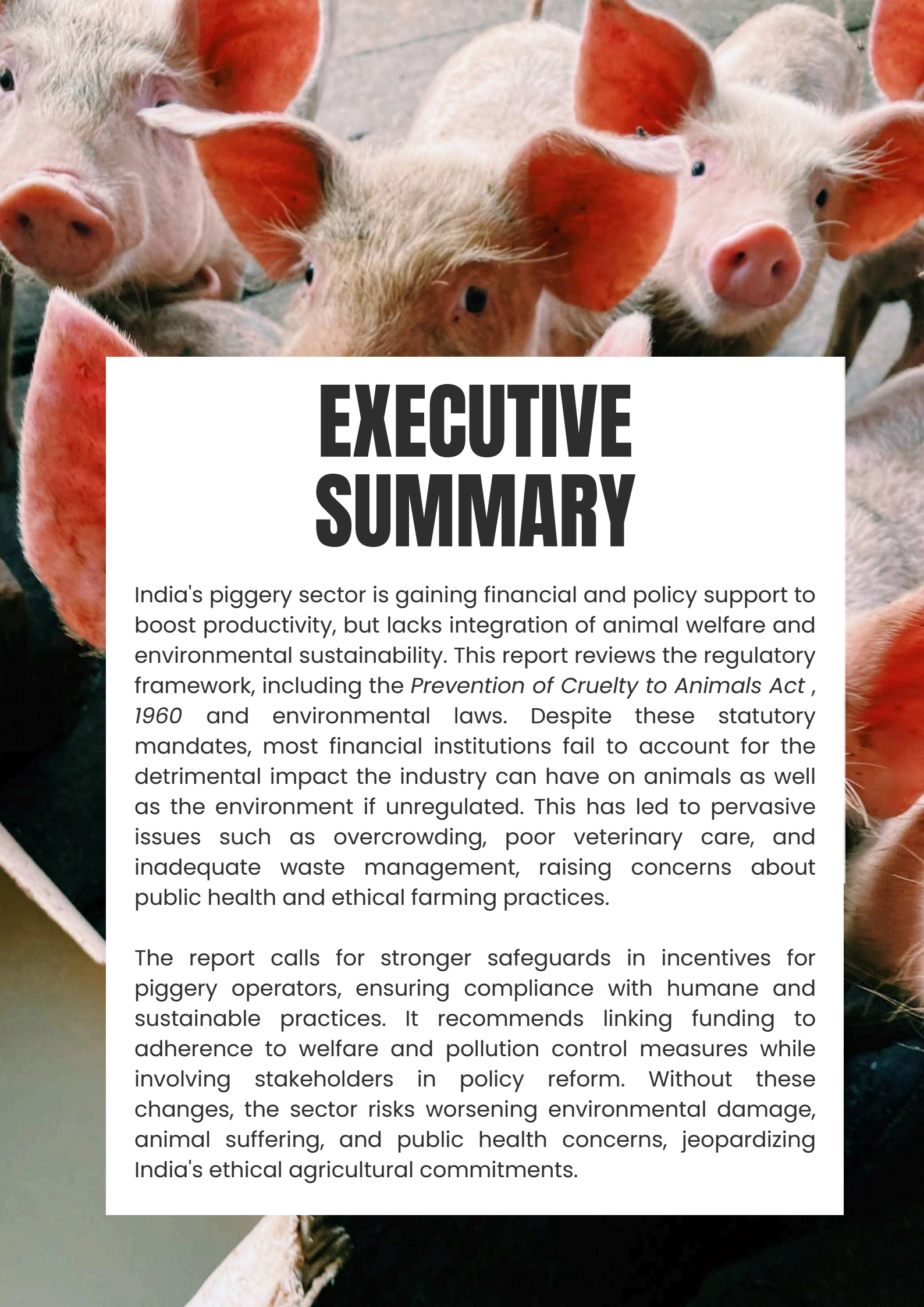
EVALUATING FINANCIAL INCENTIVES IN INDIA'S PIGGERY SECTOR



2025

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

India's piggery sector is gaining financial and policy support to boost productivity, but lacks integration of animal welfare and environmental sustainability. This report reviews the regulatory framework, including the *Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960* and environmental laws. Despite these statutory mandates, most financial institutions fail to account for the detrimental impact the industry can have on animals as well as the environment if unregulated. This has led to pervasive issues such as overcrowding, poor veterinary care, and inadequate waste management, raising concerns about public health and ethical farming practices.

The report calls for stronger safeguards in incentives for piggery operators, ensuring compliance with humane and sustainable practices. It recommends linking funding to adherence to welfare and pollution control measures while involving stakeholders in policy reform. Without these changes, the sector risks worsening environmental damage, animal suffering, and public health concerns, jeopardizing India's ethical agricultural commitments.

INTRODUCTION

India is the world's fifth largest producer in meat production. Within the meat sector, pig meat remains a relatively small contributor, accounting for just 4-5% of total meat production. However, this sector is receiving growing interest and investment, with pork production currently at 404,00,00 tonnes in 2018-19 alone. This underscores the need for analysis of financial incentives offered and safeguards incorporated therein.

As per the 20th Livestock Census conducted in 2019 by the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying ("Animal Husbandry Department, GoI"), the total population of pigs in India is 9.06 million. The top pork producing state of the country is Assam with a pig population of 2.09 million. India has a diverse population of pigs with 14 breeds of pigs characterized and registered as of July 2024. In addition to these, a substantial population of nondescript pigs remain unclassified. Currently, descript pigs make up 29.40% of the total pig population, comprising 2.80% exotic, 18.10% crossbred and 8.20% indigenous pigs. 70.60% of the Indian pig population includes non-descript pigs, which are yet to be categorized for their breed status.

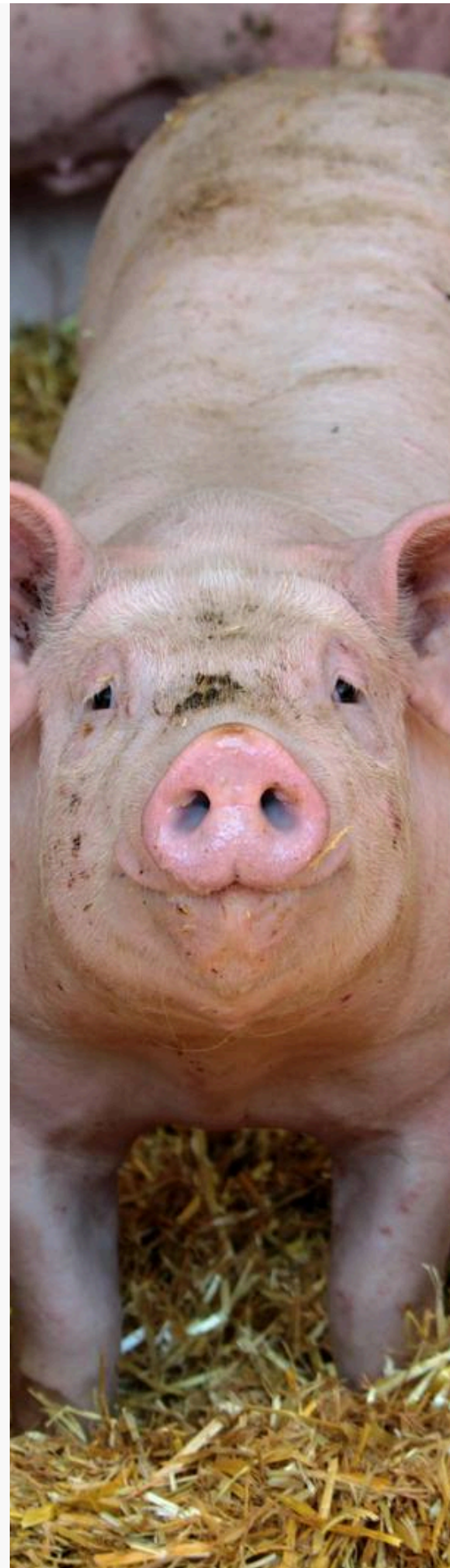


The Animal Husbandry Department, GoI has initiated key programs like the National Livestock Mission to enhance meat production and entrepreneurship while preventing disease. State-level schemes aim for self-sufficiency, with banks providing loans to support rural economies.

However, the piggery industry is fraught with poor regulation and infrastructure, compromising animal welfare and public health. Current schemes often neglect animal welfare and sustainable practices, risking inhumane conditions and environmental harm, which contradicts India's commitments to the United Nation's Sustainable Development Goals.

This report emphasizes the need to incorporate animal welfare and sustainability into financial incentives for piggery operations. A focus on productivity without these considerations leads to overcrowding, inadequate care, and environmental issues, resulting in animal suffering and health risks.

Addressing these concerns is crucial for aligning the industry with global standards and India's environmental goals. The report advocates for integrating welfare and sustainability guidelines into policies to create a more ethical and resilient piggery sector.



METHODOLOGY

There are various schemes, subsidies, and loans being offered, both at central and state levels to promote piggery operations in India. In addition, several private banks are offering loans and credit card facilities to further the development of Piggeries. For the Central and State Government schemes, reference is made to the website of Animal Husbandry Department, GoI and corresponding departments of the respective states. Banks like SBI, ICICI Bank, Canara Bank, and Union Bank of India among others, have also listed their loan facilities online. Furthermore, reference has been made to NABARD and the myScheme portal operated by the National e-Governance Division, alongside the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), for state specific schemes.

KEY SOURCES



Central & State Government Schemes - Website of the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, GoI & State Animal Husbandry Departments/State Scheme Portals



Bank Loans - Briefs, terms & conditions and other documents detailing eligibility for bank loans.



Other Sources - National Bank for Agriculture & Rural Development; *myScheme* portal operated by the National e-Governance Division

OVERVIEW OF REGULATORY FRAMEWORK

The regulatory framework governing piggery operations in India plays a critical role in ensuring animal welfare and promoting environmental sustainability.



CENTRAL ANIMAL PROTECTION STATUTES

1. The Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960

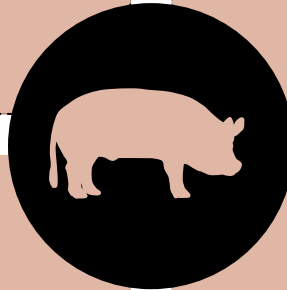
At the core of this framework is The ***Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, of 1960*** ("PCA, 1960"), and the Rules formulated thereunder which set the foundation for the humane treatment and care of animals. The specific sections of the said Act are as follows.

Section 11(1)(a).

Prohibits any person from subjecting pigs to any treatment that causes unnecessary pain and suffering.

Section 11(1)(e).

Forbids housing pigs in receptacles that do not measure sufficiently in height, length & breadth to provide reasonable opportunity for natural behaviour.



Section 11(1)(h).

Mandates that the owner of pigs provide them with sufficient food, drink and shelter.

Section 11(1)(k).

Requires pig farmers to ensure that pigs in their possession are not suffering mutilation, starvation, thirst or overcrowding.

Section 11(1)(l).

Requires pig farmers and workers at units to refrain from mutilation, encompassing methods like tail docking, teeth clipping and ear notching.

2. The Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Animal Husbandry Practices and Procedures) Rules, 2023

- *The Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Animal Husbandry Practices and Procedures) Rules, 2023*, establishes comprehensive legal provisions and guidelines for ethical animal husbandry practices across the country.
- These Rules aim to prevent inhumane treatment of animals, and can promote responsible handling of pigs in both small-scale and industrial operations.

CENTRAL ENVIRONMENT AND PUBLIC HEALTH STATUTES

1. Key Environmental Statues

From an environmental standpoint, the Central Pollution Control Board mandates that piggery unit owners obtain **Consent to Establish (CTE)** and **Consent to Operate (CTO)** as per the ***Classification of Sectors into Red, Orange, Green, White and Blue Categories*** published in January 2025. This is in accordance with the *Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981* and the *Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974*.

2. Public Health Statutes

State-level regulations like the Municipal Corporation Acts/Rules or Bye-Laws by the local bodies outline essential infrastructure and operational requirements for piggery units. These regulations cover waste management systems, sanitation protocols, and facilities that minimize environmental pollution. Effective implementation of these provisions ensures that piggery operations meet environmental standards while maintaining public health and hygiene.

Several states have introduced extensive policies tailored to local needs. For example, the Governments of Assam and Nagaland have formulated state-specific pig breeding policies that address key operational parameters. These policies emphasize the availability of high-quality feed, access to proper veterinary care, and mitigation of environmental impacts.

STATE LEVEL STATUTES



ASSAM

1. Assam Municipal Corporation Act, 2022

Section 194(d) prescribes the duty of piggery owners to dispose pig carcasses in such places as the Commissioner designates. The Act prescribes the duty of the Corporation to take adequate measures for: the licensing of pigs in Section 217(d).

2. Assam Pig Breeding Policy, 2019

The *Assam Pig Breeding Policy* was notified through the Assam Gazette dated 29.10.2020 vide *Notification No. VFV.234/2019/Pt-11/23*. Although it focuses on core issue of pig breeding for conservation and germplasm improvement, other associated issues to be addressed are also indicated as below–

- Infrastructure and Services are Underutilised: A fairly large infrastructure of veterinary institutions, vaccine and diagnostic production units, breeding farms, feed and feed crops production units are owned by the government. However, many of these resources are underutilised, and require restructuring and strengthening to ensure optimal use.
- Shortage of Feed and Feed Crops: Assam faces a significant gap between the requirement and availability of feed and feed crops, particularly when it comes to pigs. Maize is an important feed ingredient of pig feed. Due to the low popularity of maize cultivation in Assam, its market price is high – affecting accessibility. Local production or reliable supply chains for high-quality feed are crucial for efficient utilization of the genetic potential of pigs.

- Insufficient Measures to Protect Pig Health: Prevention and control measures of diseases need to be strengthened. Shortage of veterinarians and para-veterinary staff is a constraint that needs attention for action. Facilities including mechanisms for diagnosis, treatment, tracking and prevention of the diseases need to be strengthened. Adequate infrastructure for ensuring bio-security, proper quarantine systems and services to prevent the ingress of diseases across the states and national borders need to be in place.
- Pigs and the Environment: Climate change and global warming may have serious implications on the pig sector. These may be manifested in the form of heat stress, scarcity of quality feed and feed crops, and changes in epidemiological pattern of vector borne diseases etc., ultimately leading to reduction in production and therefore, economic losses. Mitigating the impact of climate change, calls for critical appraisal of the situation on a continuous basis and advance planning. Various mitigation measures have been identified to reduce the impact of climate change.





NAGALAND

1. Nagaland Pig Breeding Policy (By Department of AH & VS Nagaland: Kohima)

The Nagaland Pig Breeding Policy was notified by the Govt. of Nagaland NO. PLAN- 59/PBP/2015-16/AHV/ dated: 04.08.2016. This policy is aimed at improving the genetic trait of the existing swine population of the state, in the interest of the common farmers' economic sustainability through piggery.

A. Infrastructure: As per the Policy, the following infrastructure is required for implementation:

- Development of sheds for farrowing, grower, replacement and parent stock separately for each breed.
- Potable water plant and individual distribution system to individual pens.
- Sewage treatment plant
- Boar shed constructed specific to each breed and be provided with semen collection amenities
- Semen processing laboratory with semen bank and establishment of satellite centers.
- Feed plant with a capacity of 10-15 quintals production per day and with a storage capacity of 500 quintals.
- Provision for production of feed crops.

B. Disease Control and Bio-Security: Maintaining the health of pigs is also a key focus of the breeding policy:

- Setting up of quarantine sheds at the point of entry in Nagaland.
- Regular Vaccination against prevailing (FMD, CSF) and other emerging diseases.
- Standard operating protocol will be followed to prevent spread of diseases and other infections.

C. Manpower: Support in terms of human power is required to manage the whole system including farm managers and assistant managers with relevant specialisations; lab managers and assistants (VFA) with requisite training; livestock supervisors and so forth.

D. Capacity Building: Training to be imparted to the key staff members to manage the technical programme and properly implement the breeding policy. Training to cover semen collection, disease management, farm management, breeding, feeding, health care and management, and so forth.





KARNATAKA

1. The Karnataka Municipal Corporation Act, 1976

Section 344(a) of the Act prohibits keeping pigs without permission from the commissioner, whereas Section 367 prohibits the slaughtering of animals except in a licensed slaughter house.

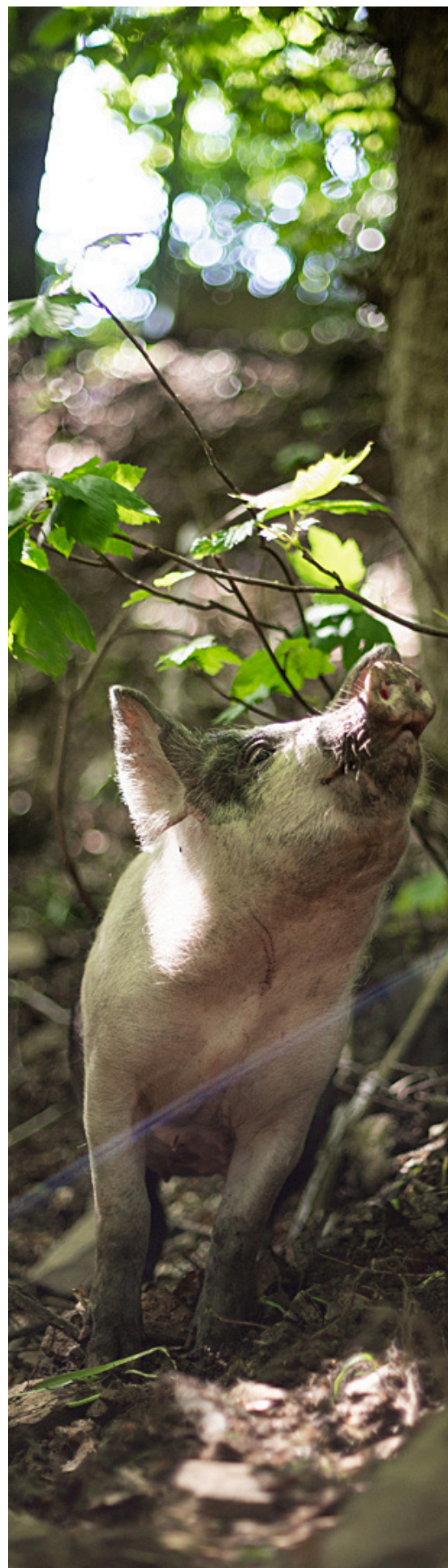


WHY FOCUS ON PIGS?

The pig meat industry in India remains one of the most **under-researched** and **unregulated sectors** within the broader meat industry. The piggery sector lacks a comparable level of scrutiny and structured oversight. This regulatory gap presents significant challenges for sustainable growth, animal welfare, and environmental protection in the industry.

Currently, piggery operations are categorised under the **“Green” category** in accordance with the pollution index score provided by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB). While this classification theoretically signifies moderate environmental impact, **ground realities often tell a different story**. Poor waste management at piggery units can contribute to severe environmental degradation through improper waste disposal, water pollution, and greenhouse gas emissions. These issues are exacerbated by the lack of monitoring and mechanisms.

From an animal welfare perspective, the **absence of any regulatory standards** allows for widespread practices that **compromise the health and well-being** of pigs. Overcrowding, inadequate veterinary care, poor feed quality, and unsanitary living conditions are common issues that remain unaddressed in many piggery units. Without mandatory welfare standards integrated into eligibility criteria for schemes or facilities supporting piggery operations, these practices are likely to persist, severely compromising animal welfare.



STATES SELECTED

A) ASSAM - As per the 20th Livestock Census 2019, the pig population of Assam is 20,99,000 which is about 23% of total pig population of our country. There are 19 Pig Breeding Farms under Animal Husbandry & Veterinary Department, Assam out of which 16 farms are functional. In addition, Bodoland Pig Mission - the flagship programme of Bodoland Territorial Council for introducing scientific pig breeding/rearing, processing, marketing and export of pork has been inaugurated in Assam.

B) NAGALAND - As per the 20th Livestock Census, 2019, the pig population of Nagaland is 4,04,695. The Department of Animal Husbandry has set targets to achieve self-sufficiency in pork meat production by 2030, with a focus on expanding piggery activities in rural areas and supplying pork to other states for export. There are 10 functional piggery units across 9 districts, from where cross breed piglets are made available to the farmers as parent stock for breeding.

C) HARYANA - As per the 20th Livestock Census 2019, the pig population of Haryana is 1,08,312. Pig farming has a special significance and plays an important role in improving the socio-economic status of a sizeable section of the weaker community. Haryana is a key location for piggery operations because of its proximity to the Delhi market where a significant demand for pork exists.

D) KARNATAKA - As per the 20th Livestock Census 2019, the pig population of Karnataka is 3,23,836. There are 10 Pig breeding centres across different districts in Karnataka. The state has an advantage of having both local pigs (Ankamali) and intensively farm grown pigs (Duroc, Yorkshire and Landrace).

KEY ANIMAL WELFARE & ENVIRONMENTAL ASPECTS

INFRASTRUCTURE AND HOUSING

A critical factor in the successful rearing of pigs is to have correct balance between the numbers in the group and the space they are allowed. Efficient utilization of pen space without adversely affecting the productivity and well-being of pigs is important for pork production (Anil et al. 2007). The relationship between animals and space can be defined in different ways, viz. space allowance per animal (m^2/animal), or stocking density (number of animals/ m^2).

1) Space Requirements – Sufficient space allocation is vital to reduce stress-induced behaviours such as tail and ear biting, which are common in overcrowded conditions. This is also mandated in Section 11(1)(e) and Section 11(1)(k) of the PCA, 1960. Adequate spacing improves feed intake and growth rates while ensuring better overall health and welfare. Overcrowding has been linked to increased aggression, injuries, and susceptibility to diseases, emphasizing the importance of adhering to these space guidelines.



Type of animal	Weight of animal (kg)	Covered floor area per animal (m2)	Open yard area per animal (m2)
Boar	Up to 120	625	8.800
	121 to 199	7.000	10.500
	200 and above	7.500	1.200
Farrowing Sow	Up to 120	7.500	880
	121 to 199	8.250	105
	200 and above	9.000	1.200
Weaner	Up to 20	960	96
Grower	21-70	150	150
Finisher	71 and above	180	180
Dry Sow or Gilt	Up to 80	180	180
	81- 150	225	225
	151 and above	270	270

Applicable Provisions: Section 11(1)(e) and Section 11(1)(k) of the PCA, 1960

2) Housing of Pigs – Section 11(1)(h) of PCA, 1960 mandates that owners of piggery units must provide adequate and appropriate shelter for the animals under their care. Ensuring proper housing is essential to safeguard the well-being, health, and natural behavior of pigs. The specific requirements for suitable housing of pigs, so as to prevent unnecessary pain and suffering, are outlined below:

The roof must be rainproof, to shield pigs from adverse weather conditions.

The floor should be raised about 60 cms for better drainage, to protect pigs during calamities such as flooding.

Strong, impervious as well as non slippery walls are necessary to withstand the rooting habits of pigs.

Good ventilation and ample shade are essential for maintaining air quality and temperature control.

Applicable Provisions: Section 11(1)(h) of the PCA, 1960

2) Equipments & Allied Units – Crates are narrow metal enclosures used to house and transport pigs. They are used in many piggery units today to maximise the number of pigs confined in limited space. Sows are confined in Gestation Crates for approximately 114 days, while they are housed in Farrowing Crates a few days prior to delivery of piglets and for several weeks thereafter. Sows in these crates suffer high levels of physiological and psychological distress. However, Section 11(1)(e) of the PCA, 1960, explicitly states that confining an animal in a cage or receptacle that does not provide adequate height, length, and breadth for reasonable movement constitutes cruelty. Therefore, the use of crates should be strictly curtailed when designing shelters for pigs to ensure their well-being and compliance with the law.

Other equipments used in the design of pig shelters are as follows:

- Pig Feeding Troughs: Provision for giving the pigs access to sufficient feed, both in terms of quantity and quality.
- Pig waterers or water troughs: Devices designed to provide a consistent and hygienic water supply to pigs measuring adequately in size.

Applicable Provisions: Section 11(1)(e), 11(1)(h), 11(1)(k) of the PCA, 1960



3) Veterinary & Husbandry Services - Adopting scientific husbandry services is key to the welfare of pigs. Breeding techniques should be strictly monitored and must be performed under the supervision of a registered veterinary practitioner. Painful and prohibited mutilation practices such as teeth clipping and tail docking should be refrained from, with alternatives like enriched environments being prioritised. This will ensure compliance with section 11(1)(l) of the PCA, 1960 and Rule 9 (e) of the *Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Animal Husbandry Practices and Procedures) Rules, 2023*; which prohibit the mutilation of animals in an unnecessarily cruel manner.

Applicable Provisions: Section 11(1)(l) of the PCA, 1960, Rule 9(e) of the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Animal Husbandry Practices and Procedures) Rules, 2023

4) Feed Provisions – Section 11(1)(h) of the PCA, 1960 requires piggery owners to provide adequate food, water, and shelter for pigs. A balanced diet containing carbohydrates, proteins, fats, minerals, and vitamins enhances growth and feed efficiency. Nutritional needs vary based on factors like breed, age, and physiological status, necessitating adjustments in feed formulation.

ICAR-NRCP (2024) recommends dividing nutrient requirements into three post-weaning stages: 8-16 weeks, 17-24 weeks, and 25-35 weeks, and categorizes them by growth rates for both exotic and indigenous breeds. Nutritional guidelines for pregnant gilts and lactating sows are also specified in phases. The BIS (1987) outlines feeding stages: starter/creep feed, grower feed, and finisher feed, which are widely followed in India.

Type of Animal	Covered Area (m ² /animal)	Open Paddock (m ² /animal)
Stage I	Starter/Creep Feed	up to 2 months, Body weight : 5 – 12 kg
Stage II	Grower Feed	2 to 5 months, Body weight : 12 – 50 kg
Stage III	Finisher Feed	After 5 months, Body weight : 50 – 100 kg

Applicable Provisions: Section 11(1)(h), 11(1)(k) of the PCA, 1960.

ENVIRONMENTAL ASPECTS

1) Consent from the State Pollution Authority – All piggery unit owners must obtain Consent to Establish (CTE) and Consent to Operate (CTO) from the State Pollution Control Boards/Pollution Control Committees as piggeries are classified in the **Green category** of CPCB'S *Classification of Sectors into Red, Orange, Green, White and Blue Categories, January 2025*. This would ensure the necessary compliance to the *Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981* and the *Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974*.

Applicable Provisions: CTE & CTO from the State Pollution Control Boards/Pollution Control Committees



2) Solid Waste Management Systems -

- An adult pig excretes around 6.4 kg of dung daily, rich in nitrogen and phosphorus. If not managed properly, this can cause eutrophication of water bodies and harm aquatic ecosystems. Scientific dung management protects soil and groundwater, and prevents heavy metals like zinc and copper from entering crops and the food chain.
- Carcass dumping in drains, canals, and water bodies is common—especially during disease outbreaks, when thousands are discarded. Carcasses must be separated from live animals and buried within 12 hours.

Applicable Provisions: Infrastructure for proper segregation and storage of the solid waste generated at premises.



2) Liquid Waste Management Systems -

- Globally, pig farms produce about 900 kg of wastewater per pig annually, consisting of manure, urine, and wash water. Many units lack proper treatment systems, often dumping waste into pits, drains, or fields without treatment.
- This leads to groundwater contamination and ecosystem damage. Proper treatment using septic tanks, soak pits, or effluent treatment plants is essential to protect water bodies, soil, and crops from eutrophication and heavy metal buildup.

Applicable Provisions: Provisions for scientific treatment and disposal of liquid waste.

3) Biomedical Waste Management:

- Biomedical waste discarded from piggery units includes used syringes, needles and medications/drugs.
- Such waste requires careful segregation and distinct disposal channels.
- It is commonplace to find biomedical waste mixed with general waste and disposed of in drains, in open fields – increasing the risk of pathogen spread and exposure to antimicrobial residue.

Applicable Provisions: Facilities dedicated for proper handling, segregation, and disposal of bio-medical waste.



FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE FOR PIGGERY OPERATIONS



CENTRAL GOVERNMENT SCHEMES AND SUBSIDIES

1. National Livestock Mission:

- **Objective & Components:** The National Livestock Mission, started in 2014 and revised in 2021, aims to generate employment opportunities, develop entrepreneurship and increase the per animal productivity. It has provision to provide 50% up to Rs. 30 lakh capital subsidy towards the capital cost of the project. The funding will be provided for the cost of housing, breeding animals along with transportation and insurance cost, equipment machines.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

2. Animal Health & Infrastructure Development Fund

- **Objectives & Components:** This scheme aims to promote exports and increase the export contribution in the milk and meat sector, develop entrepreneurship and generate employment, and to make available quality concentrated animals feed to the cattle, buffalo, sheep, goat, pig and poultry to provide balanced ration at affordable prices. It has provisions to offer loans up to 90% of the estimated/actual project cost from the Scheduled Bank based on submission of viable projects by eligible beneficiaries.
- **Safeguards:** The Scheme has certain safeguards, namely, requiring the piggery operator to furnish the following-
 - Consent to Establish (CTE) and Consent to Operate (CTO) from the respective State Pollution Control Board
 - Trade License
 - License from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)
 - Documents supporting compliance under the *Water(Prevention And Control of Pollution) Act, 1974*, and *Air(Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981*
 - Permits from the State Electricity Board
 - Local Authority Clearances as per the State Requirements

3. Livestock Health & Disease Control scheme:

- **Objectives & Components:** This scheme aims to control Classical Swine Fever (CSF) by vaccinating the entire pig population, to provide veterinary services at the farmers' doorstep through Mobile Veterinary Units (MVUs), and to assist States/UTs for Control of Animal Disease (ASCAD) by prevention & control of important livestock and poultry diseases prevalent in different States/UTs as per their priorities.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

STATE GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

1. Assam Milk, Meat & Egg Mission Society(AMMEMS-CMSGUY):

- **Objectives & Components:** Aims to make the state surplus in pig production with an objective to export to other states.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

2. Haryana - Piggery Farming Scheme by Haryana Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (HSFDC):

- **Objectives & Components:** The Scheme aims to generate employment opportunities for individuals who belong to the Scheduled Caste and are below the poverty line. It entails a Project Cost Ceiling of Up to Rs. 1,50,000 /-. Subsidy is provided at 50% of the total project cost (maximum amount of subsidy is Rs. 10,000/-). Besides subsidy, the composite loan i.e. subsidy, and the balance amount of the bank loan is provided by the banks to the seller of the assets on behalf of the beneficiaries.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

STATE GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

3. Nagaland Area Development Scheme 2018-23:

- **Objectives & Components:** To double farmers income and attain self-sufficiency in pork production with focussed development of piggery activities in rural areas by the year 2030 including supply to other States/ export to other countries.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

4. Karnataka Pashu Bhagya Scheme:

- **Objectives & Components:** The Department of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Sciences, Karnataka provides subsidy and loan under the *Pashu Bhagya Scheme* as detailed below:
 - Back ended subsidy of 50% to farmers belonging to Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribes and 25% to other small and marginal farmers will be provided to establish cattle, sheep, goat, pig, poultry units in availing maximum loan of Rs.1.20 lakh from commercial banks.
 - Short term loans up to Rs.50,000/- at 0% interest will be provided through Co-operative Banks, on the lines of crop loan, for providing cattle feed/other maintenance expenditure.
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

INTERNATIONAL FINANCIAL AID

1. Assam Project On Agri-Business And Rural Transformation (APART).

- **Objectives & Components:** The Government of Assam through the Central Government has applied for a credit of US\$200 million from the International Development Association (IDA) – a wing of the World Bank group, for implementation of the Assam Project on Agribusiness and Rural Transformation (APART). APART is currently under the preparatory stage and will span across 16 districts in Assam.
 - Project Development Objective – To add value and improve resilience of selected agriculture value chains, focusing on smallholder farmers and agro-entrepreneurs in targeted districts of Assam.
 - The project broadly focuses on two components:
 - Pork Value Chain (PVC): To be implemented by the Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Department.
 - Milk Value Chain (MVC) Interventions by AHVD in the Cross Cutting areas under Formal Dairy Sector [by West Assam Milk Union Limited (WAMUL)] and Informal Dairy Sector by Dairy Development Department (DDD)
- **Safeguards:** The scheme does not require any clearances for animal welfare or environmental safety.

BANK LOANS

1. Piggery Loan by Canara Bank:

- **Objectives and Components:** Canara Bank provides piggery loans for establishment or improvement of piggery units including purchase of boars, sows, feeds and construction of pig sty.
- **Safeguards:**
 - There should be sufficient accommodation for the existing animals as well as those proposed to be purchased.
 - Veterinary assistance should be readily available.
 - Feeds should be easily available at a reasonable cost.
 - Necessary Permission from municipal authorities, where ever needed.

Amount	Loan Margin
Up to Rs. 2,00,000	Nil
Above Rs. 2,00,000	15-20%

2. Agri Business loan by Union Bank:

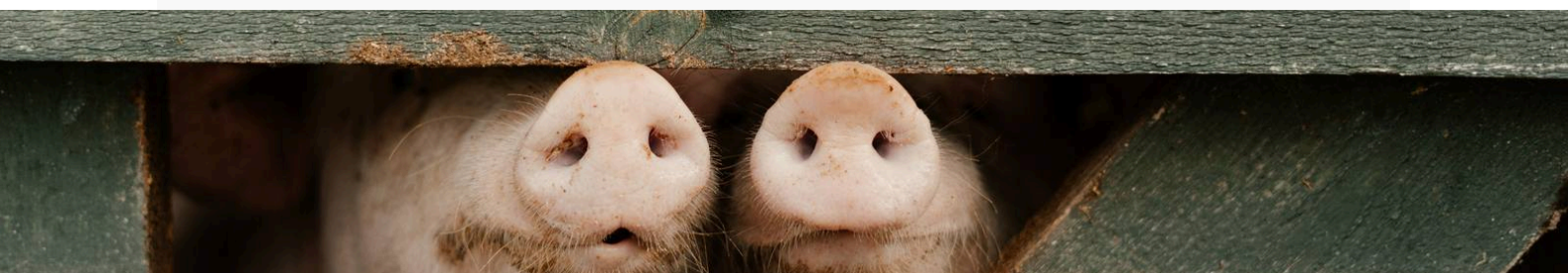
- **Objectives and Components:** Agri Business loan aims to popularise the scientific pig breeding cum rearing of meat producing animals to modernise the Indian pig industry and to improve the productivity of small sized rural pig farms.
- **Safeguards:** This loan doesn't have any animal welfare or sustainability aspects as a part of the eligibility criteria.

Amount	Loan Margin
Up to Rs. 2,00,000	Nil
Above Rs. 2,00,000	Minimum 10%

3. Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojna(PMMY)-Allied Agri by SBI:

- **Objectives & Components:** This scheme aims to create employment and generate income for livelihood and to support agriculture GDP growth.
- **Safeguards:** This scheme doesn't have any animal welfare or sustainability aspects as a part of the eligibility criteria.

Amount	Loan Margin
Upto Rs. 50,000	Nil
Rs. 50,000 to Rs. 10,00,000	10%



4. Shreyas (SAL) by Karnataka Gramin Bank:

- **Objectives & Components:** This scheme aims to promote animal Husbandry activities like dairy, Poultry, Piggery, Sheep & Goat rearing. The maximum limit is Rs. 5.00 lakhs or 75% of Project Cost or 50% of the net value of landed property or required by the party or Annual Gross Income from the Agriculture whichever is less.
- **Safeguards:** This loan doesn't have any animal welfare or sustainability aspects as a part of the eligibility criteria.

Amount	Loan Margin
Up to Rs. 1,00,000	Nil
Above Rs. 1,00,000	15%

5. Financing growth & transforming rural India by Bank of Baroda:

- **Objectives & Components:** This scheme aims to transform rural India through financial development of dairy, poultry, fisheries, piggeries etc.
- **Safeguards:** This scheme doesn't have any animal welfare or sustainability aspects as a part of the eligibility criteria.

Amount	Loan Margin
Up to Rs. 1,00,000	Nil
Over Rs. 1,00,000	15%

6. Kissan Credit Card:

- **Objectives & Components:** In the Budget 2018-19, the Union Government had announced their decision to extend the facilities of Kisan Credit Card (KCC) to animal farmers and fisheries to meet the short term credit requirements of rearing of animals, birds and fish, including pigs. Multiple banks such as Canara Bank, Union Bank of India, ICICI Bank, Bank of India offer KCC. The Interest rebate facility under Kisan Credit Card Scheme is Rs. 3 lakhs, each farmer can get a loan facility of Rs. 1.60 lakh without any security.
- **Safeguards:** This scheme doesn't have any animal welfare or sustainability aspects as a part of the eligibility criteria.

Amount	Loan Margin
For cash credit	No separate margin
For upto Rs. 1,00,000	Nil
For term loan above Rs. 1,00,000	15%

ASSESSING FINANCIAL INCENTIVES FOR WELFARE & SUSTAINABILITY

Of the key animal welfare and environmental aspects detailed earlier, the following are relevant to financial incentives currently offered by financial institutions –

1. Animal Welfare Standards:

- Section 11(e) of *the*, mandates that pigs be housed in enclosures spacious enough to allow for their natural movements, promoting their physical well-being.
- In addition, Section 11(1)(h) and Section 11(1)(k) of the aforesaid Act require piggery owners to ensure the pigs have access to sufficient food, clean drinking water, and adequate shelter that prevents overcrowding, thereby safeguarding their basic welfare.
- Adhering to these provisions is essential to prevent unnecessary suffering and promote the humane treatment of pigs throughout their growth cycle. Upholding these standards reflects the fundamental values of compassion and ethical responsibility enshrined in Indian law.

- **Environmental Compliance:**

The CPCB mandates that all piggery units obtain CTE-CTO under its *Classification of Sectors into Red, Orange, Green, White and Blue Categories*. Piggery operators should develop wastewater treatment plants, solid waste treatment protocols and biomedical waste management systems to enhance sustainability. These measures play a crucial role in balancing economic activities with environmental responsibility, fostering a more sustainable approach to pig farming.

Incorporating these measures into financial support schemes for piggery operations directly contributes to India's commitment to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals:

		
Clean Water and Sanitation- Preventing water contamination from piggery waste safeguards local water bodies and drinking water sources.	Responsible Consumption and Production- Encouraging ethical and sustainable livestock farming ensures resource efficiency and waste reduction.	Climate Action – Mitigating the environmental impact of pig farming helps reduce greenhouse gas emissions and supports long-term climate resilience.

FINANCIAL INCENTIVE EVALUATION

The following table assesses the financial incentives based on key parameters of animal welfare and sustainability, ensuring a comprehensive analysis of their impact on ethical farming practices and environmental responsibility.

P1: Infrastructure and Housing

P2: Equipments for smooth functioning of piggery units

P3: Veterinary services available at the piggery units

P4: Electricity connection available

P5: Feed Provision

P6: Consent to Establish and Consent to Operate

P7: Waste Management

Central Government Schemes							
Scheme Name	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7
National Livestock Mission	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund	×	×	×	✓	×	✓	✓
Livestock Health and Disease Control	×	×	✓	×	×	×	×

State Government Schemes							
Scheme Name	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7
Assam Milk, Meat & Egg Mission Society	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Piggery Farming Scheme	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Piggery Farming Scheme by HSFDC	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Area Development Scheme	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Pashu Bhagya Scheme	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Encouragement for Pig and Poultry Farming	×	×	×	×	×	×	×

International Aid							
Aid Programme	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7
Assam Project On Agri-Business And Rural Transformat ion	×	×	×	×	×	×	×

Bank Schemes							
Loan Name	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7
Piggery Loan by Canara Bank	✓	×	✓	×	✓	×	✓
Agri Business loan by Union Bank	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojna (PMMY)- Allied Agri by SBI	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Shreyas (SAL) by Karnataka Gramin Bank	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Financing growth & transformin g rural India by Bank of Baroda	×	×	×	×	×	×	×

CONCLUSIONS

The data presented above highlights a critical gap in the existing financial support schemes for piggery operations in India – the absence of mandatory animal welfare and sustainability criteria. This oversight is not just an ethical concern but a pressing national issue with far-reaching consequences for public health, environmental sustainability, and the future of responsible livestock farming.

The absence of regulations enforcing humane animal husbandry practices and environmentally responsible farming methods has significant repercussions:

- **Public Health Risks:** Unregulated pig farming can lead to unsanitary conditions, heightening the risk of zoonotic diseases, antibiotic resistance, and contamination of air and water sources, directly endangering public health.
- **Environmental Degradation:** Poor waste management and unchecked pollution from piggery units contribute to water contamination, deforestation, and greenhouse gas emissions, accelerating climate change and biodiversity loss.
- **Failure to Meet Global Commitments:** As a signatory to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), India must ensure that its agricultural policies align with targets such as clean water (Goal 6), responsible production (Goal 12), and climate action (Goal 13). The absence of sustainability measures in financial support schemes hinders our progress toward these global benchmarks.

To address these urgent challenges, financial aid for piggery operations must be contingent upon adherence to robust animal welfare and environmental standards. Without integrating strong welfare and environmental criteria into financial support schemes, India risks reinforcing outdated and harmful farming models rather than fostering a future of responsible and sustainable agriculture.

RECOMMENDATIONS

To ensure that India's piggery sector develops in a manner that is both economically sustainable and ethically responsible, it is crucial to integrate animal welfare criteria into all government schemes and financial support programs for the industry. **The following measures are recommended:**

1. Incorporating Animal Welfare Standards:

- Animal Husbandry Department, GoI should incorporate the 7 key welfare parameters detailed in this report into their Central Schemes.
- Animal Husbandry Department, GoI should issue directives to all State Animal Husbandry Departments to integrate the 7 key welfare parameters within their State Scheme terms and conditions.
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) should issue directions to all banks across the country to ensure minimum welfare safeguards drawing from the key parameters.
- Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) should introduce animal welfare due diligence as a criterion for approving Foreign Direct Investment proposals in pig farming.

2. Encouraging Sustainable Practices:

- Financial support for piggery operations should be contingent on the adoption of sustainable farming practices, including waste management, biosecurity, and sustainable feed production, to minimise the environmental impact of pig farming.
- Piggery operators or prospective farmers should be required to submit a copy of the Consent to Establish (CTE) obtained prior to sanction of financial aid.



3. Capacity Building and Training

- Capacity building/training of financial institutions and their personnel to ensure that aid extended follows from ensuring humane animal husbandry practices, disease prevention, fostering a shift towards more responsible farming.

4. Monitoring and Enforcement

- Implement a system of monitoring and enforcement to ensure compliance with animal welfare and sustainability standards by agents extending financial aid. This could include regular inspections and third-party audits of piggeries receiving financial support.
- Capacity building/training of financial institutions and their personnel to ensure that aid extended follows from ensuring humane animal husbandry practices, disease prevention, fostering a shift towards more responsible farming.



We are prepared to assist in structuring financial incentives to ensure sustainable growth and positive impact on animal welfare and the environment within India's piggery sector.



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